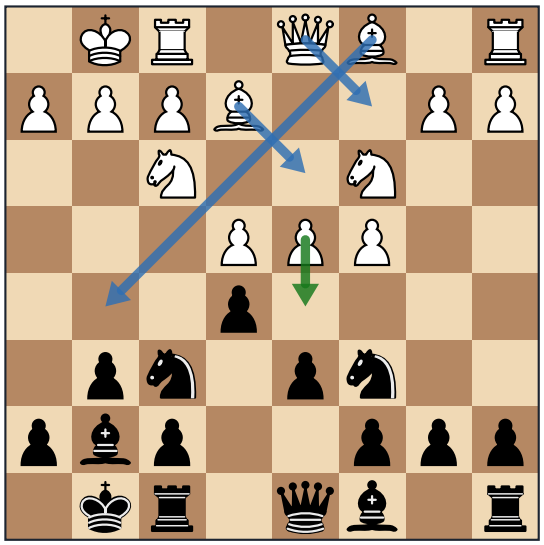
# King's Indian Defense

ECO E60-E99 | 119 named lines | Nimzo / Queen's Indian / Catalan family

**In one sentence:** Flexible, high-level systems: Black controls e4 with pieces; White fights with the bishop pair, the center or a fianchetto.

**Memory pattern:** Control e4 with pieces, then break with ...d5 or ...c5.



Main line: 1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 e5 7.O-O Nc6

### Key ideas

**1.** Nimzo: pin Nc3 and fight for e4; trade the bishop for knight to damage structure.
**2.** Queen's Indian: Bb7 and ...Be7 control e4 without weaknesses.
**3.** Catalan: use the long diagonal and queenside pressure.
**4.** Bogo-Indian: solid, flexible and low-risk for Black.
**5.** Plans revolve around e4, the c-file, and whether White gets the bishop pair.

### Reading the diagram

Blue arrows = thematic plan moves for the side to move. Green arrow = engine's best move.
Engine at the end of the main line: **+0.42** (slightly better for White, depth 16). Best: d5.

## The five coach questions

| | |
|---|---|
| **1. Ideal pawn structure?** | Black controls e4 with pieces (pin on c3 or Bb7) while White takes the c4/d4 centre or the bishop pair. Catalan: White uses g3/Bg2 pressure on d5 and the long diagonal. |
| **2. Where does my king go?** | Kings castle short; Black often keeps a healthy pawn structure by giving up the bishop pair. |
| **3. Best minor pieces?** | Black: Bb4/Bb7 and the long diagonal. White: Nc3, Bd3, Qc2, e4 break; Catalan: Bg2, Qc2, Nbd2. |
| **4. Main middlegame plan?** | White occupies the centre with e4 or plays a3/Bxc3 structures; Black strikes with ...d5/...c5 and piece pressure. |
| **5. What does my opponent want?** | White wants the bishop pair and a big centre; Black wants to restrain e4 and hit the centre. |

# The main line, move by move

Most common continuation in the database: 1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 e5 7.O-O Nc6

| Move | Why it is played |
|---|---|
| 1. d4 | Take the center. Occupies the center with a pawn. |
| 1... Nf6 | Develops the knight to f6. |
| 2. c4 | Space. Pawn move that supports the center or prepares a break. |
| 2... g6 | Gains space on the wing. |
| 3. Nc3 | Develops the knight to c3. |
| 3... Bg7 | Fianchetto: the bishop takes the long diagonal. |
| 4. e4 | Central break. Occupies the center with a pawn. |
| 4... d6 | Pawn move that supports the center or prepares a break. |
| 5. Nf3 | Develops the knight to f3. |
| 5... O-O | Castles: the king reaches safety and the rook joins the center. |
| 6. Be2 | Develops the bishop to e2. |
| 6... e5 | Occupies the center with a pawn. |
| 7. O-O | Castles: the king reaches safety and the rook joins the center. |
| 7... Nc6 | Develops the knight to c6. |



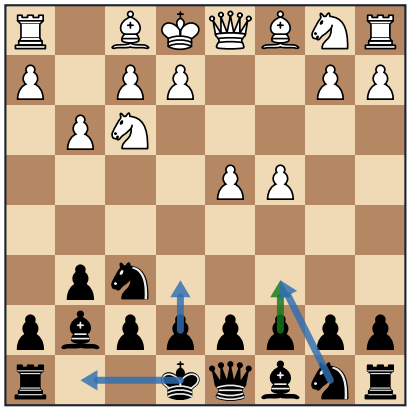
After 1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6



After 4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6

# Key variations

The most important named branches (ranked by how much theory lies beneath them). Diagram arrows: blue = plan moves, green = Stockfish.

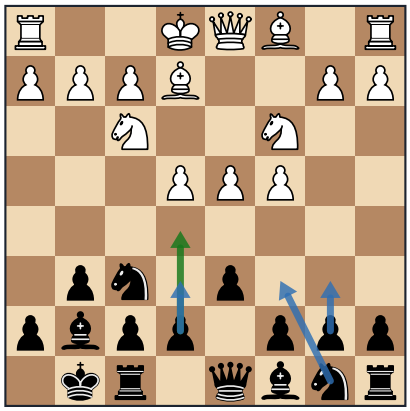


Position after the line

### Fianchetto Variation E60 | 27 lines

`1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nf3 Bg7 4.g3`

Stockfish: **+0.28** (slightly better for White, depth 15). Best next move: c6.
What to look for: Nf6 (develop); e6 (solid); Bb4 (pin Nc3)
Sub-variations: Panno Variation, Yugoslav Variation, Immediate Fianchetto, Benjamin Defense

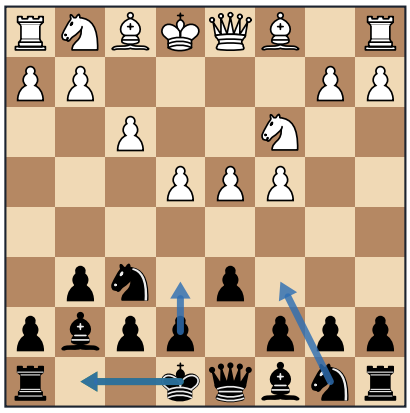


Position after the line

### Orthodox Variation E91 | 22 lines

`1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2`

Stockfish: **+0.44** (slightly better for White, depth 16). Best next move: e5.
What to look for: Nf6 (develop); e6 (solid); Bb4 (pin Nc3)
Sub-variations: Classical System, Positional Defense, Bayonet Attack, Gligoric-Taimanov System

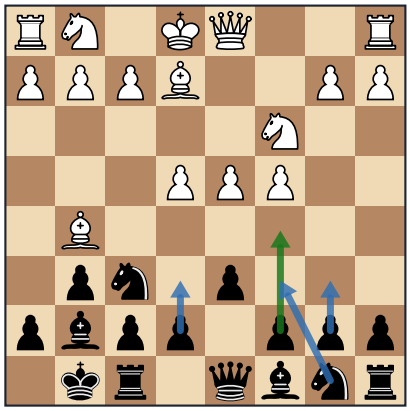


Position after the line

### Sämisch Variation E80 | 18 lines

`1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f3`

Stockfish: **+0.37** (slightly better for White, depth 14). Best next move: O-O.
What to look for: Nf6 (develop); e6 (solid); Bb4 (pin Nc3)
Sub-variations: Closed Variation, Orthodox Variation, Bobotsov-Korchnoi-Petrosian Variation, Byrne Defense



Position after the line

### Averbakh Variation E73 | 11 lines

`1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Be2 O-O 6.Bg5`

Stockfish: **+0.38** (slightly better for White, depth 15). Best next move: c5.
What to look for: Nf6 (develop); e6 (solid); Bb4 (pin Nc3)
Sub-variations: Benoni Defense, Modern Defense, Flexible Defense, Geller Defense

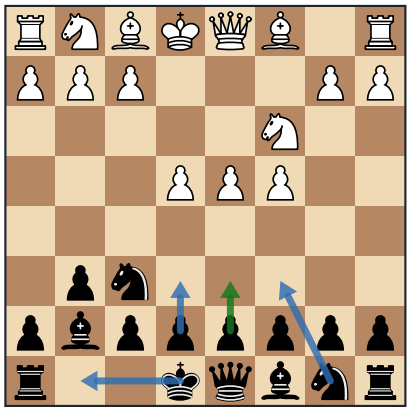


Position after the line

### Four Pawns Attack E76 | 8 lines

`1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f4`

Stockfish: **+0.37** (slightly better for White, depth 17). Best next move: O-O.
What to look for: Nf6 (develop); e6 (solid); Bb4 (pin Nc3)
Sub-variations: Dynamic Attack, Modern Defense, Florentine Gambit, Normal Attack



Position after the line

### Normal Variation E70 | 6 lines

`1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4`

Stockfish: **+0.52** (slightly better for White, depth 16). Best next move: d6.
What to look for: Nf6 (develop); e6 (solid); Bb4 (pin Nc3)
Sub-variations: King's Knight Variation, Deferred Fianchetto, Standard Development, Rare Defenses

## Detailed repertoire notes

**King's Indian Defense** (E60-E99, Black)

```
1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 e5 7.O-O Nc6 8.d5 Ne7 9.Ne1 Nd7 10.Be3 f5 11.f3 f4
12.Bf2 g5 13.a4 Ng6 14.Nd3 Nf6 15.c5 Rf7
```

**Idea:** Allow White a big center, then attack it with ...e5 and ...f5. The g7 bishop becomes a monster once the center locks.

**Structure:** Locked center: White c4-d5-e4 vs Black d6-e5. White plays c5 on the queenside; Black plays ...f5-f4 and ...g5 on the kingside.

**Pieces:** Bg7 (best), knights e8/d7/g6, queen e8/e7, rooks f8/g8.

**Plan:** Castle, ...e5, ...Nbd7, ...Ne8, then ...f5 and a pawn storm (...f4, ...g5). If White opens the center, use the bishop and e-file.

**King:** Castle early, then ...f5 and ...g5; White often castles long. **Opponent:** Queenside expansion (c5), space, Bg5/h3 breaks and trading the g7 bishop.

**Watch out:** Do not push ...f5 too early before pieces are ready; know the Samisch and Bayonet.

# Expert and coach view

Nimzowitsch (Nimzo-Indian), Karpov and Kramnik (Catalan) are strongly linked to these systems.

### What a coach would tell you

Learn the key structure: doubled c-pawns versus bishop pair (Nimzo), the long diagonal fight (Catalan) and the e4 break. Play solid, flexible moves and avoid early commitments.

### Why play it

Flexible, high-level systems: Black controls e4 with pieces; White fights with the bishop pair, the center or a fianchetto.

### Typical mistakes

- Giving up the bishop pair without compensation (Nimzo).
- Playing ...d5 too early before the pieces are developed.
- Letting White play e4 with a big center unopposed.

### Typical tactics and traps

- Bxc3 followed by Ng5 or e4 winning the pinned knight if Black is careless.
- Qa4+ forks after ...b5 in Catalan lines.

### Endgame and middlegame outlook

Balanced endgames with small edges decided by structure and bishops.

### Study checklist

[ ] Play the main line on a board and say each move's purpose aloud.

[ ] Learn the five coach questions by heart; answer them without notes.

[ ] Drill two sub-variations until the moves feel automatic.

[ ] Play three games with the opening, then review where you left theory.

[ ] Re-read the traps page the day before a tournament.

# The opening tree

Every named line in this family as a tree. Gray moves are inherited from the parent; green after the arrow are the new moves that define the variation. Large green dots mark branches with 10 or more lines.

- **King's Indian Defense (all lines)** — E61
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3
  - **Fianchetto Variation** — E60
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nf3 Bg7 4.g3
    - **Immediate Fianchetto** — E60
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.g3
    - **Delayed Fianchetto** — E62
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.Nf3 d6 5.g3
    - **Pterodactyl Variation** — E64
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nf3 Bg7 4.g3 -> 4...c5 5.Bg2 Qa5
    - **Carlsbad Variation** — E62
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.g3 Bg7 4.Bg2 O-O 5.Nc3 d6 6.Nf3 Nc6
    - **Debrecen Defense** — E67
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.g3 Bg7 4.Bg2 O-O 5.Nc3 d6 6.Nf3 Nbd7
    - **Yugoslav System** — E64
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nf3 Bg7 4.g3 -> 4...d6 5.Bg2 O-O 6.O-O c5
    - **Yugoslav Variation** — E65
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nf3 Bg7 4.g3 -> 4...O-O 5.Bg2 d6 6.O-O c5 7.Nc3
      - **Rare Line** — E64
        1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.g3 Bg7 4.Bg2 O-O 5.Nc3 d6 6.Nf3 c5
      - **Advance Line** — E66
        1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nf3 Bg7 4.g3 O-O 5.Bg2 d6 6.O-O c5 7.Nc3 -> 7...Nc6 8.d5
      - **Exchange Line** — E65
        1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nf3 Bg7 4.g3 O-O 5.Bg2 d6 6.O-O c5 7.Nc3 -> 7...Nc6 8.dxc5 dxc5
    - **Benjamin Defense** — E61
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.Nf3 d6 5.g3 O-O 6.Bg2 c6 7.O-O Qb6
    - **Classical Fianchetto** — E67
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nf3 Bg7 4.g3 -> 4...O-O 5.Bg2 d6 6.O-O Nbd7 7.Nc3 e5
    - **Hungarian Variation** — E64
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nf3 Bg7 4.g3 -> 4...d6 5.Bg2 O-O 6.O-O Nbd7 7.Nc3 a6
    - **Kavalek Defense** — E62
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nf3 Bg7 4.g3 -> 4...O-O 5.Bg2 d6 6.O-O c6 7.Nc3 Qa5
    - **Larsen Defense** — E62
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.Nf3 d6 5.g3 O-O 6.Bg2 c6 7.O-O Bf5
    - **Lesser Simagin (Spassky)** — E62
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.g3 Bg7 4.Bg2 O-O 5.Nc3 d6 6.Nf3 Nc6 7.O-O Bf5
    - **Panno Variation** — E63
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nf3 Bg7 4.g3 -> 4...O-O 5.Bg2 d6 6.O-O Nc6 7.Nc3 a6
      - **Korchnoi Line** — E63
        1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nf3 Bg7 4.g3 O-O 5.Bg2 d6 6.O-O Nc6 7.Nc3 a6 -> 8.h3 Rb8 9.Be3 b5 10.Nd2
      - **Blockade Line** — E63
        1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nf3 Bg7 4.g3 O-O 5.Bg2 d6 6.O-O Nc6 7.Nc3 a6 -> 8.d5 Na5 9.Nd2 c5 10.Qc2 e5
      - **Donner Line** — E63
        1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nf3 Bg7 4.g3 O-O 5.Bg2 d6 6.O-O Nc6 7.Nc3 a6 -> 8.d5 Na5 9.Nd2 c5 10.Qc2 Rb8 11.b3 b5 1…
    - **Simagin Variation** — E62
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.Nf3 d6 5.g3 O-O 6.Bg2 Nc6 7.O-O Bg4
    - **Uhlmann-Szabo System** — E62
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nf3 Bg7 4.g3 -> 4...O-O 5.Bg2 d6 6.O-O Nc6 7.Nc3 e5
    - **Classical Variation** — E68
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nf3 Bg7 4.g3 -> 4...O-O 5.Bg2 d6 6.O-O Nbd7 7.Nc3 e5 8.e4
    - **Double Fianchetto Attack** — E64
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nf3 Bg7 4.g3 -> 4...d6 5.Bg2 O-O 6.O-O Nbd7 7.Nc3 e5 8.b3
    - **Classical Main Line** — E69
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nf3 Bg7 4.g3 -> 4...O-O 5.Bg2 d6 6.O-O Nbd7 7.Nc3 e5 8.e4 c6 9.h3
    - **Long Variation** — E68
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.Nf3 d6 5.g3 O-O 6.Bg2 Nbd7 7.O-O e5 8.e4 Re8 9.h3 exd4 10.Nxd4 Nc5 11.Re1 a5
  - **Normal Variation** — E70
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 -> 3...Bg7 4.e4

- **King's Knight Variation** E60
  1.d4 Nf6 2.Nf3 g6 3.c4
- **Deferred Fianchetto** E72
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 -> 4...d6 5.g3
- **Rare Defenses** E90
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 -> 4...d6 5.Nf3
- **Standard Development** E73
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 -> 4...d6 5.Be2
- **Santasiere Variation** E60
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nf3 Bg7 4.b4
- **Accelerated Averbakh Variation** E70
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 -> 3...Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Bg5
- **Four Pawns Attack** E76
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 -> 3...Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f4
  - **Modern Defense** E76
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f4 -> 5...Na6
  - **Dynamic Attack** E76
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f4 -> 5...O-O 6.Nf3 c5 7.d5
  - **Fluid Attack** E78
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f4 -> 5...O-O 6.Nf3 c5 7.Be2
  - **Normal Attack** E77
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f4 -> 5...O-O 6.Nf3 c5 7.d5 e6 8.Be2
  - **Exchange Variation** E79
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f4 -> 5...O-O 6.Nf3 c5 7.Be2 cxd4 8.Nxd4 Nc6 9.Be3
  - **Florentine Gambit** E77
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f4 -> 5...O-O 6.Nf3 c5 7.d5 e6 8.Be2 exd5 9.e5
- **Kramer Variation** E70
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 -> 3...Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nge2
- **Makogonov Variation** E71
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 -> 3...Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.h3
- **Smyslov Variation** E61
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 -> 3...Bg7 4.Nf3 d6 5.Bg5
- **Sämisch Variation** E80
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 -> 3...Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f3
  - **Normal Defense** E81
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f3 -> 5...O-O
  - **Bobotsov-Korchnoi-Petrosian Variation** E81
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f3 -> 5...O-O 6.Nge2
  - **Double Fianchetto** E82
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f3 -> 5...O-O 6.Be3 b6
  - **Orthodox Variation** E85
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f3 -> 5...O-O 6.Be3 e5
    - **Bronstein Variation** E87
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f3 O-O 6.Be3 e5 -> 7.d5 Nh5 8.Qd2 Qh4 9.g3 Nxg3 10.Qf2 Nxf1 11.Qxh4 …
  - **Sämisch Gambit** E81
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f3 -> 5...O-O 6.Be3 c5
  - **Yates Defense** E83
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f3 -> 5...O-O 6.Be3 Nc6
  - **Closed Variation** E87
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f3 -> 5...O-O 6.Be3 e5 7.d5
    - **Main Line** E89
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f3 O-O 6.Be3 e5 7.Nge2 c6 8.d5 cxd5
  - **Byrne Defense** E81
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f3 -> 5...O-O 6.Be3 c6 7.Bd3 a6
  - **Panno Formation** E83
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f3 -> 5...O-O 6.Be3 Nc6 7.Nge2 a6
  - **Ruban Variation** E83
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f3 -> 5...O-O 6.Be3 Nc6 7.Nge2 Rb8

- **Panno Main Line** E84
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f3 -> 5...O-O 6.Be3 Nc6 7.Nge2 a6 8.Qd2 Rb8
- **Sämisch Gambit Accepted** E81
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f3 -> 5...O-O 6.Be3 c5 7.dxc5 dxc5 8.Qxd8 Rxd8 9.Bxc5
- **Bronstein Defense** E87
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f3 -> 5...O-O 6.Be3 e5 7.d5 Nh5 8.Qd2 Qh4 9.g3 Nxg3 10.Qf2 Nxf1 11.Qxh4 N…
- **Averbakh Variation** E73
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 -> 3...Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Be2 O-O 6.Bg5
  - **Benoni Defense** E74
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Be2 O-O 6.Bg5 -> 6...c5
    - **Advance Variation** E74
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Be2 O-O 6.Bg5 c5 -> 7.d5
    - **Exchange Variation** E74
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Be2 O-O 6.Bg5 c5 -> 7.dxc5
  - **Flexible Defense** E73
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Be2 O-O 6.Bg5 -> 6...h6
  - **Geller Defense** E73
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Be2 O-O 6.Bg5 -> 6...Nbd7
  - **Modern Defense** E73
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Be2 O-O 6.Bg5 -> 6...Na6
    - **Burgess Line** E73
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Be2 O-O 6.Bg5 Na6 -> 7.Qd2 c6
  - **Nc6 Defense** E73
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Be2 O-O 6.Bg5 -> 6...Nc6
  - **Spanish Defense** E73
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Be2 O-O 6.Bg5 -> 6...a6
  - **Main Line** E75
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Be2 O-O 6.Bg5 -> 6...c5 7.d5 e6
- **Karpov System** E71
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 -> 3...Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.h3 O-O 6.Be3
- **Larsen Variation** E90
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 -> 3...Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be3
- **Orthodox Variation** E91
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 -> 3...Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2
  - **Gligoric-Taimanov System** E92
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 -> 6...e5 7.Be3
  - **Aronin-Taimanov Defense** E97
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 -> 6...e5 7.O-O Nc6
  - **Donner Defense** E94
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 -> 6...e5 7.O-O c6
  - **Glek Defense** E94
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 -> 6...e5 7.O-O Na6
  - **Positional Defense** E94
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 d6 3.Nc3 Nbd7 4.e4 e5 5.Nf3 g6 6.Be2 Bg7 7.O-O O-O
    - **Closed Line** E94
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 Nbd7 7.O-O e5 8.d5
    - **Main Line** E96
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 e5 7.O-O Nbd7 8.Re1 c6 9.Bf1 a5
  - **Ukrainian Defense** E94
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 -> 6...e5 7.O-O a5
  - **Bayonet Attack** E97
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 -> 6...e5 7.O-O Nc6 8.d5 Ne7 9.b4
    - **Sokolov's Line** E97
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 e5 7.O-O Nc6 8.d5 Ne7 9.b4 -> 9...Nh5 10.Re1
    - **Yepishin's Line** E97
      1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 e5 7.O-O Nc6 8.d5 Ne7 9.b4 -> 9...Nh5 10.Qc2
  - **Classical System** E98
    1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 -> 6...e5 7.O-O Nc6 8.d5 Ne7 9.Ne1

- **Neo-Classical Line** E98
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 e5 7.O-O Nc6 8.d5 Ne7 9.Ne1 -> 9...Nd7 10.Be3
- **Traditional Line** E99
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 e5 7.O-O Nc6 8.d5 Ne7 9.Ne1 -> 9...Nd7 10.f3 f5
- **Benko Attack** E99
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 e5 7.O-O Nc6 8.d5 Ne7 9.Ne1 -> 9...Nd7 10.f3 f5 11.g4
- **Kozul Gambit** E98
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 e5 7.O-O Nc6 8.d5 Ne7 9.Ne1 -> 9...Nd7 10.Be3 f5 11.f…
- **Korchnoi Attack** E97
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 -> 6...e5 7.O-O Nc6 8.d5 Ne7 9.Bd2
- **Modern System** E97
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 -> 6...e5 7.O-O Nc6 8.d5 Ne7 9.Nd2
- **Semi-Averbakh System** E73
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 -> 3...Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Be2 O-O 6.Be3
- **Semi-Classical Variation** E61
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 -> 3...Bg7 4.Nf3 O-O 5.e3 d6 6.Be2
- **Benoni Variation** E60
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.Nf3 O-O 5.e3 d6 6.Be2 -> 6...c6
- **Hollywood Variation** E60
  1.d4 Nf6 2.Nf3 g6 3.c4 Bg7 4.Nc3 O-O 5.e3 d6 6.Be2 Nc6
- **Queenside Storm Line** E61
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.Nf3 O-O 5.e3 d6 6.Be2 -> 6...Nbd7 7.O-O e5 8.b4
- **Exchange Variation** E61
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.Nf3 O-O 5.e3 d6 6.Be2 -> 6...Nbd7 7.O-O e5 8.dxe5 dxe5
- **Steiner Attack** E81
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 -> 3...Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f3 O-O 6.Bg5
- **Zinnowitz Variation** E90
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 -> 3...Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Bg5
- **Kazakh Variation** E91
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 -> 3...Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 Na6
- **Exchange Variation** E92
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 -> 3...Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 e5 7.dxe5
- **Petrosian Variation** E92
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 -> 3...Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 e5 7.d5
- **Normal Defense** E93
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 e5 7.d5 -> 7...Nbd7
- **Stein Defense** E92
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 e5 7.d5 -> 7...a5
- **Keres Defense** E93
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O 6.Be2 e5 7.d5 -> 7...Nbd7 8.Bg5 h6 9.Bh4 g5 10.Bg3 Nh5 11.h4
- **Pomar System** E72
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 -> 3...Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.g3 O-O 6.Bg2 e5 7.Nge2
- **Six Pawns Attack** E77
  1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 -> 3...Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.f4 O-O 6.Be2 c5 7.d5 e6 8.dxe6 fxe6 9.g4 Nc6 10.h4

# One-page memory sheet

### Move-order pattern

```
1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6 5.Nf3 O-O
```

### Plan chain

| | |
|---|---|
| **White** | d4 -> c4 -> Nc3 -> Nf3 -> g3 |
| **Black** | Nf6 -> e6 -> Bb4 -> b6 -> Bb7 |

### Three rules to remember

1. Control e4 with pieces, then break with ...d5 or ...c5.

2. White occupies the centre with e4 or plays a3/Bxc3 structures; Black strikes with ...d5/...c5 and piece pressure.

3. White wants the bishop pair and a big centre; Black wants to restrain e4 and hit the centre.

### Pawn structure in one line

Black controls e4 with pieces (pin on c3 or Bb7) while White takes the c4/d4 centre or the bishop pair. Catalan: White uses g3/Bg2 pressure on d5 and the long diagonal.